

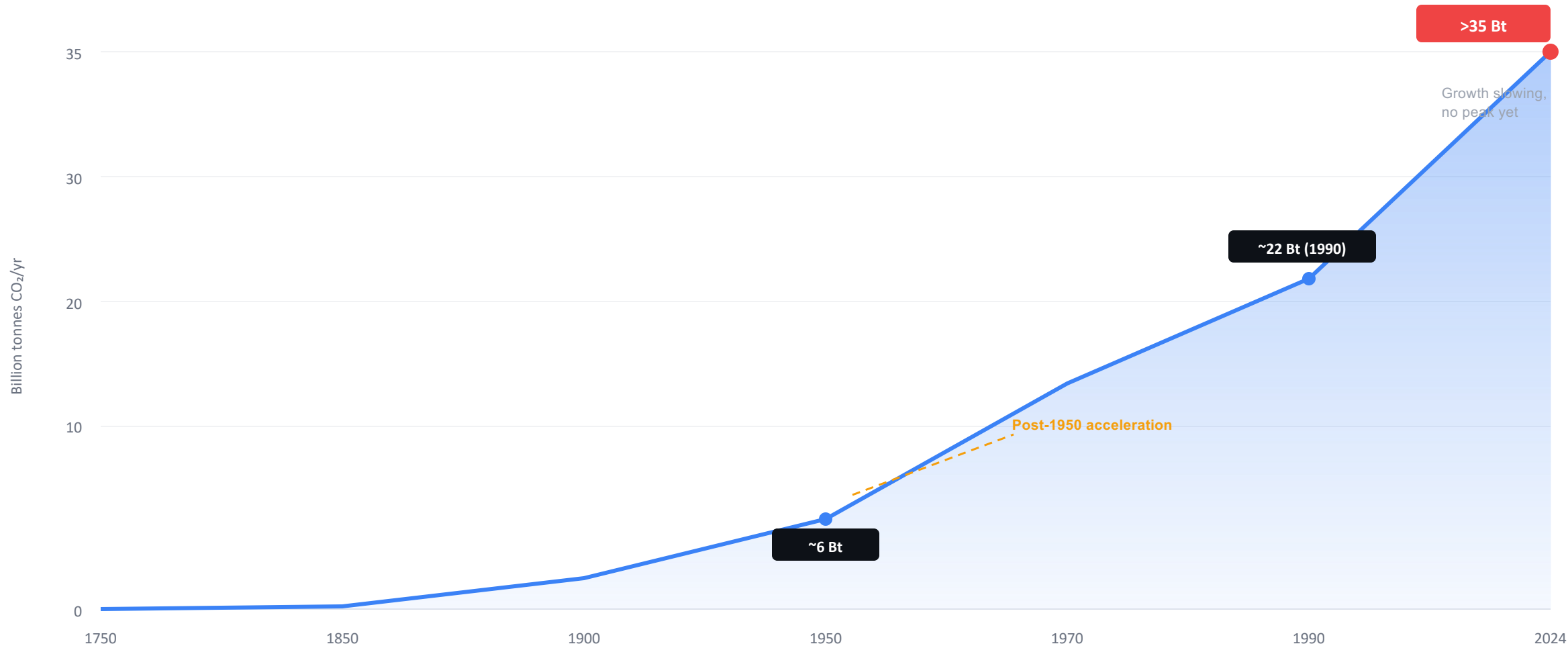


Global CO₂ Emissions Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

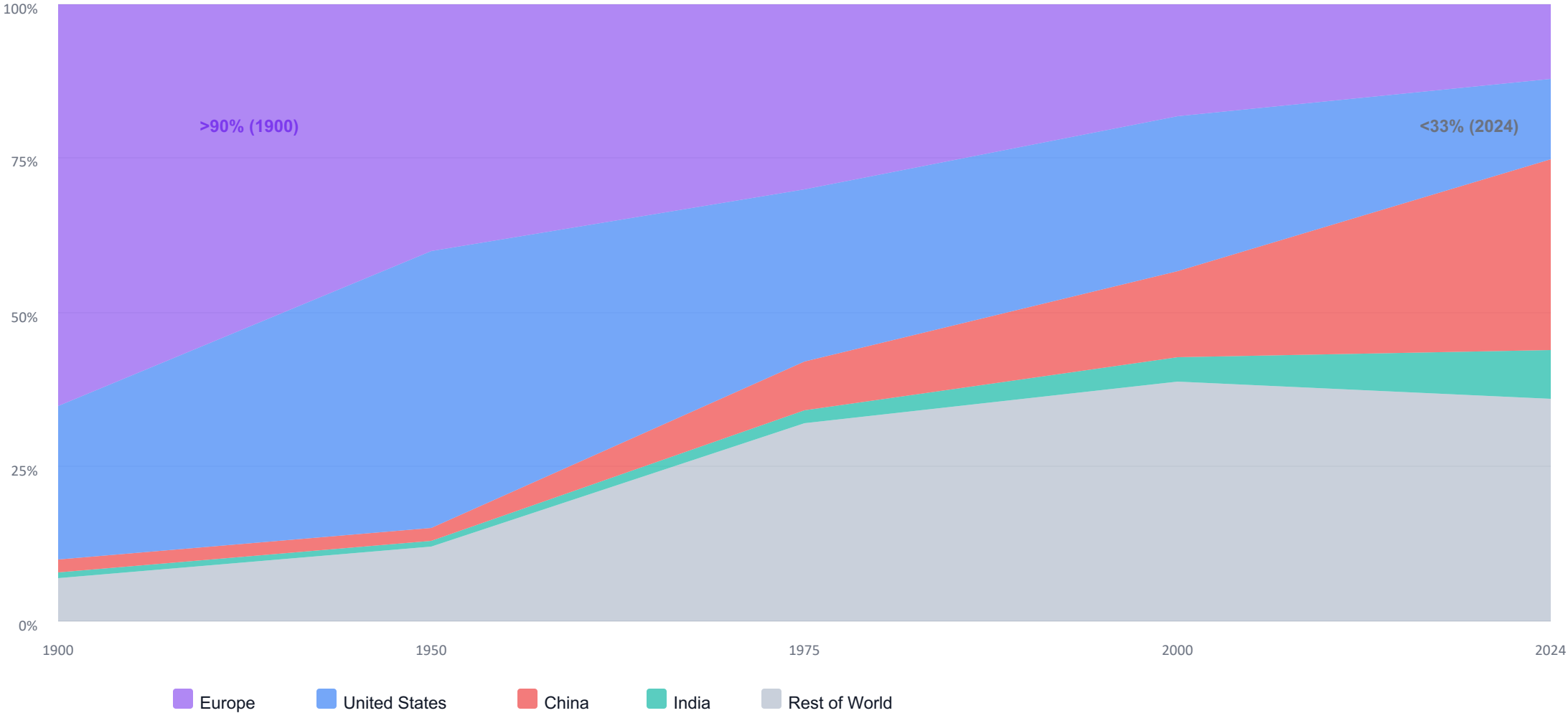
Fossil Fuels & Industry · 1750–2024

Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via [Our World in Data](#)

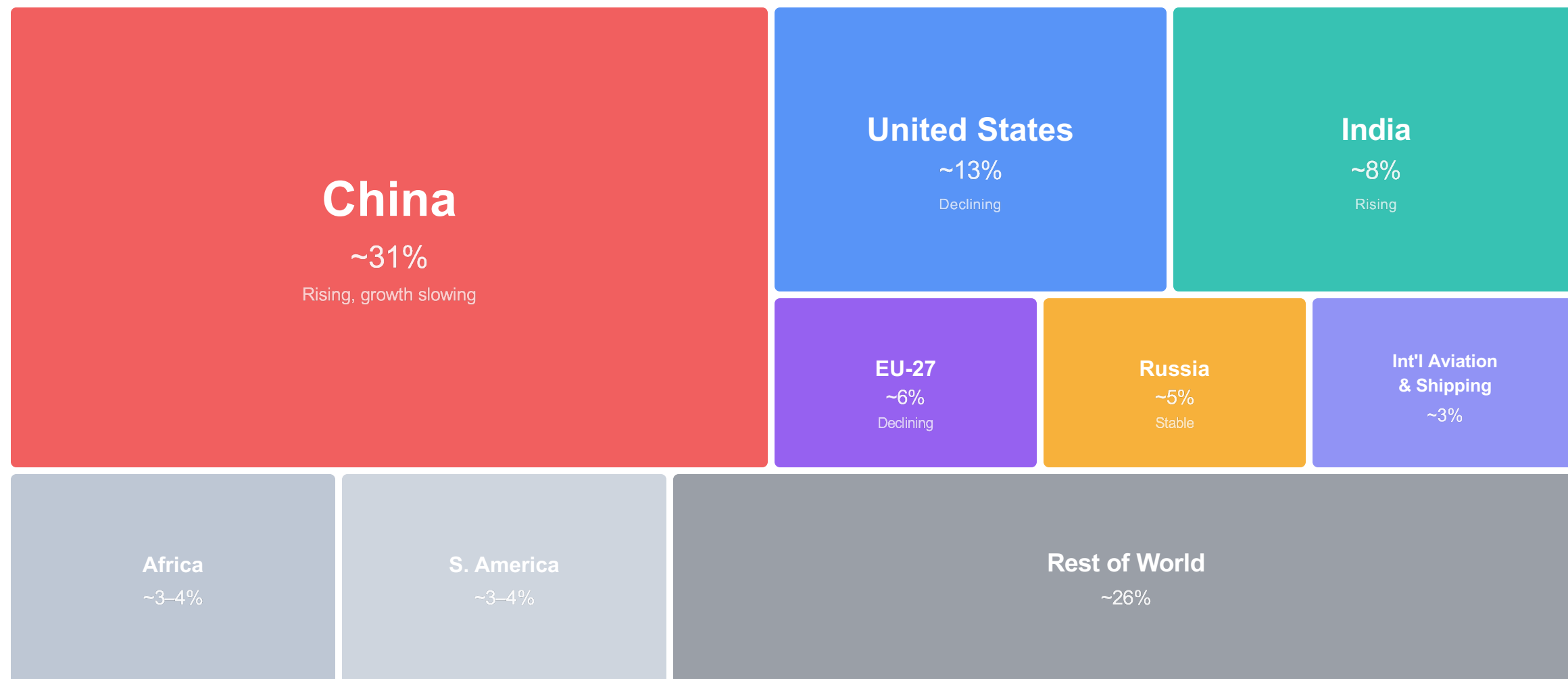
Global CO₂ emissions grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to over 35 Bt today — and have not yet peaked



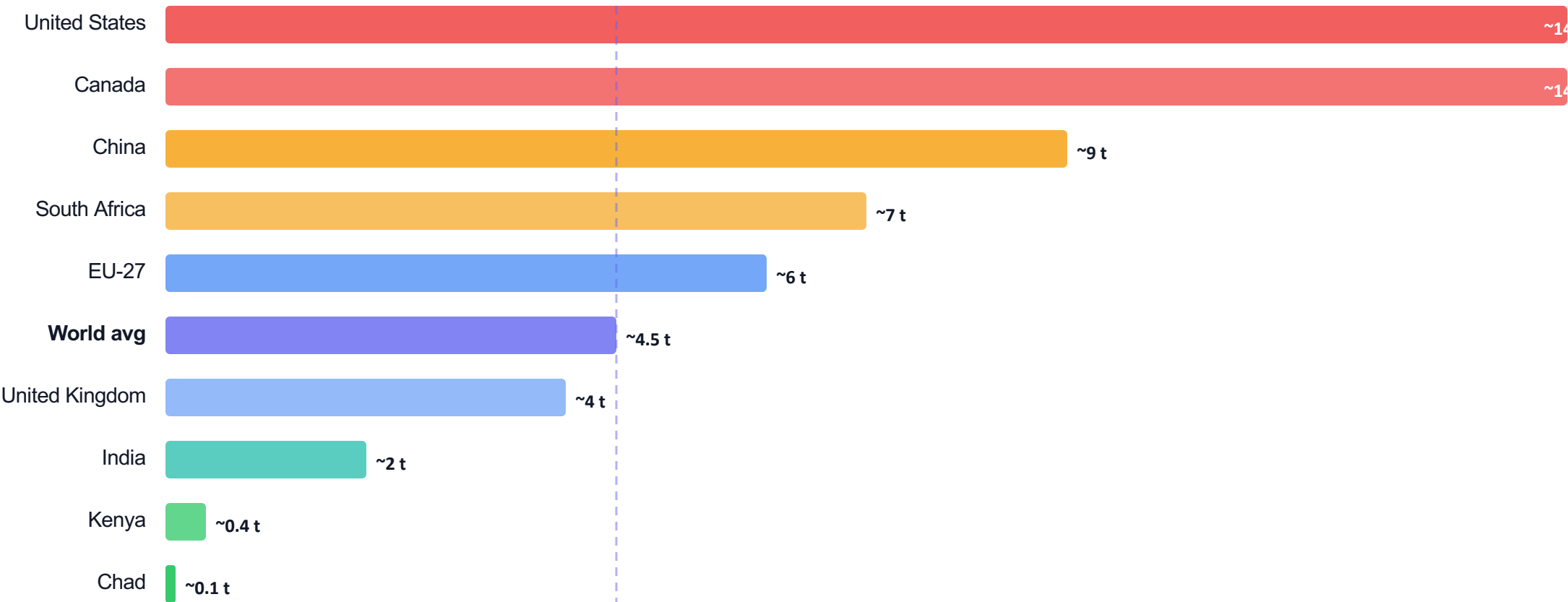
Europe and the US fell from >90% of emissions in 1900 to under one-third today



China now emits ~31% of global CO₂ — more than the US and EU combined



A 150× gap: from 0.1 t/person in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada



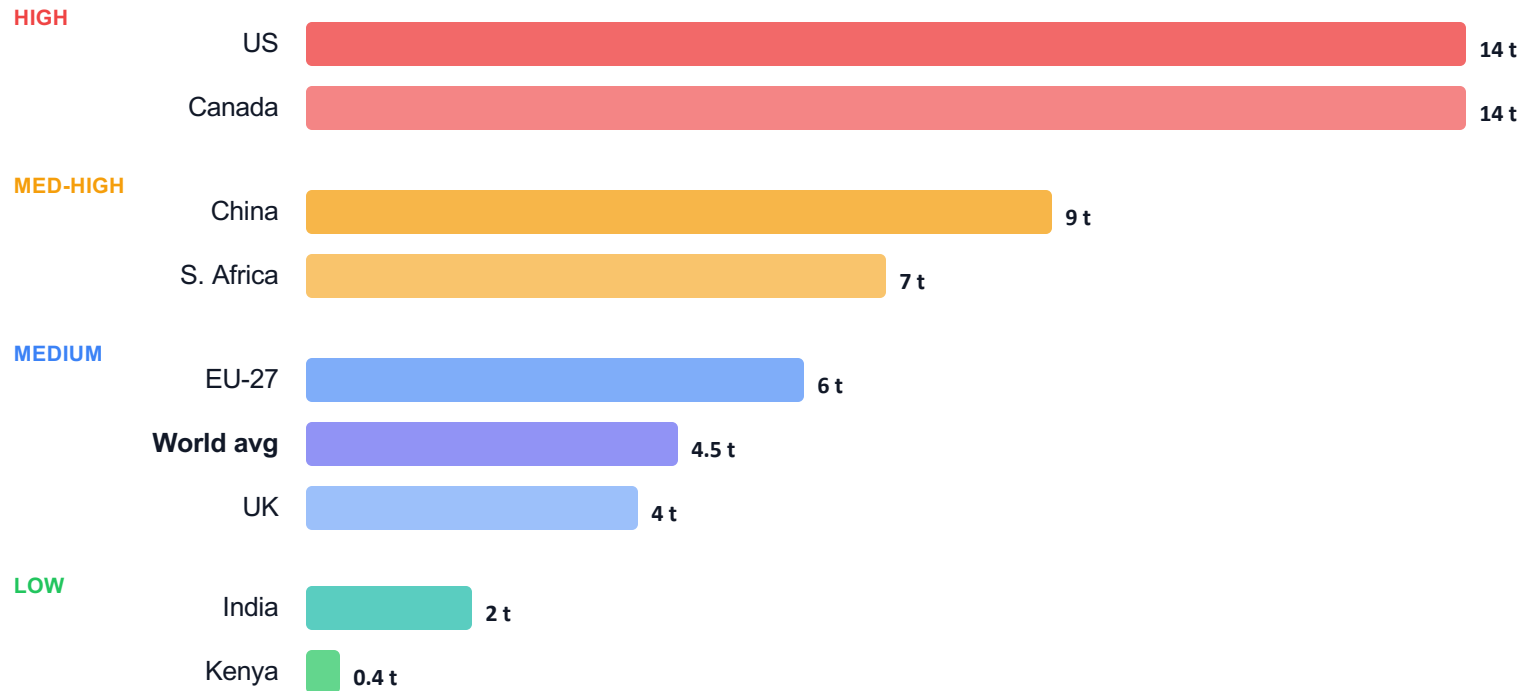
150×

gap between highest and lowest

The average American emits in under 2 days what the average person in Chad emits in an entire year.

World avg 4.5 t

Per capita: ~14 t in the US vs ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India — total ≠ responsibility



China: Largest total, below US per capita

China emits ~31% of global CO₂ but its per capita rate (~9 t) is still 36% less than the US.

Total emissions ≠ per capita responsibility.

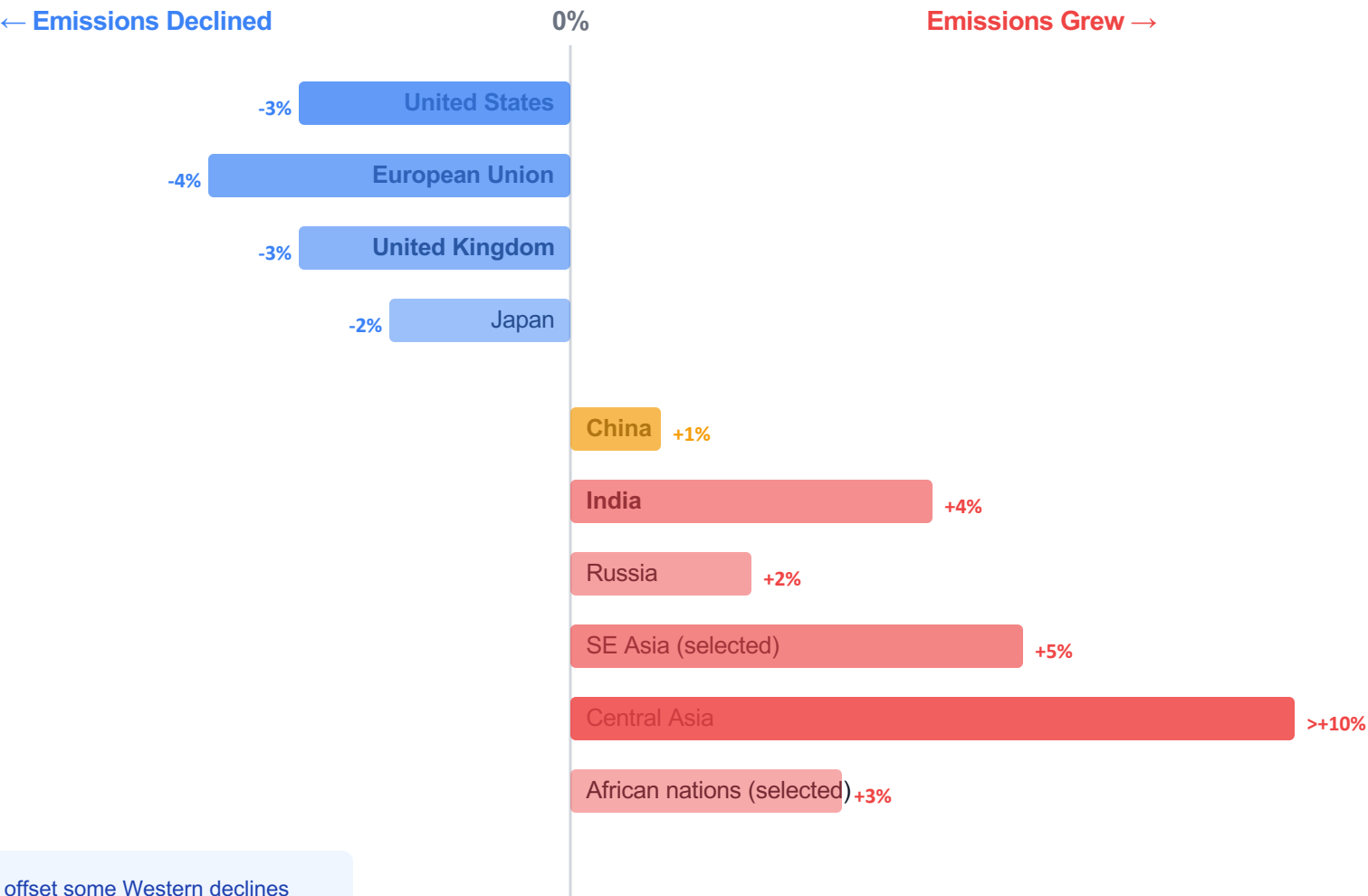
India: 1.4 billion people, only ~2 t each

Despite being the 3rd largest total emitter, India's per capita is well below world average.

Wealthy nations are not equal

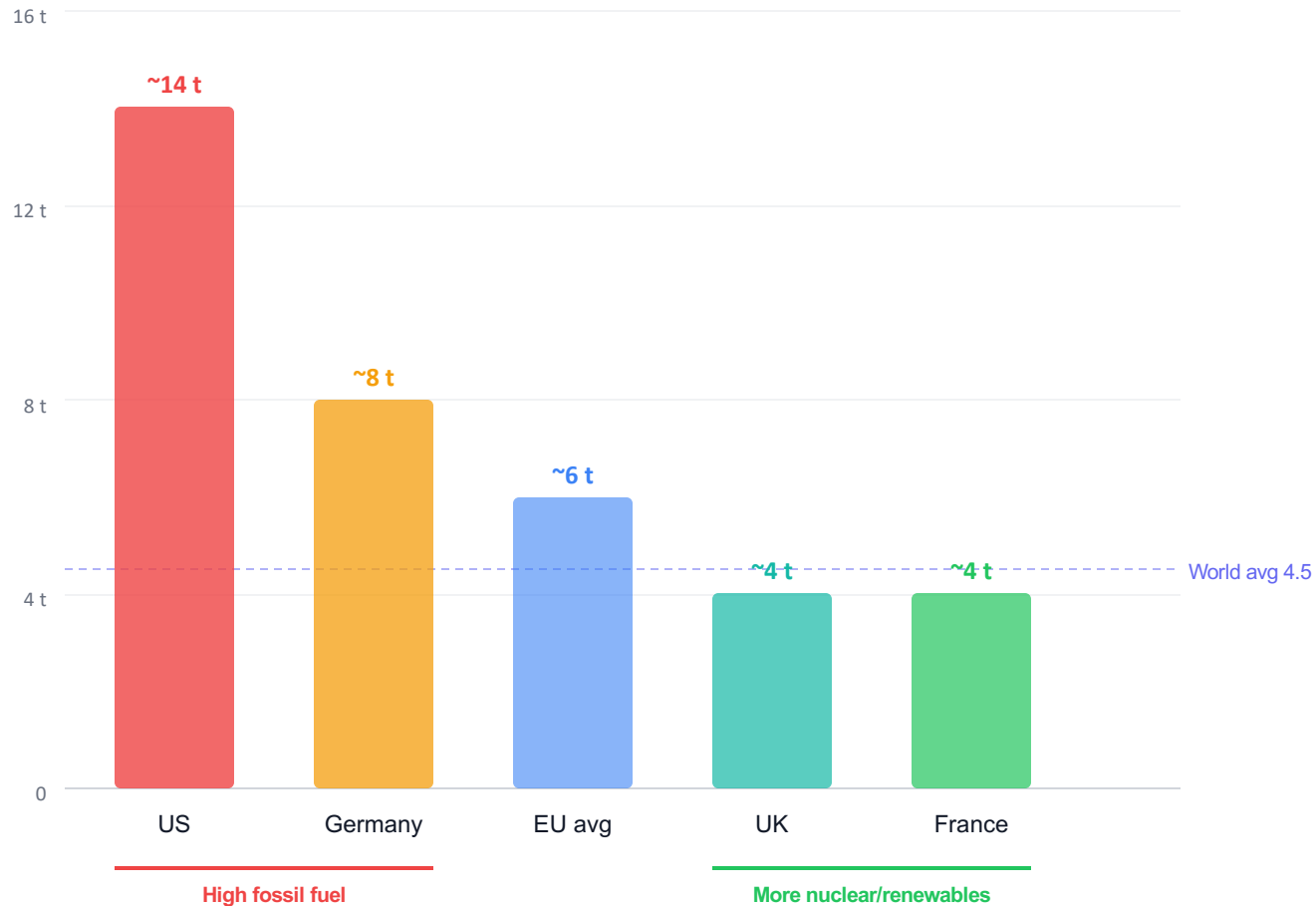
The UK (~4 t) emits far less per capita than the US (~14 t) despite similar GDP.

2024: Many Western nations cut emissions while parts of Asia and Africa grew



Energy mix explains why France and the UK emit far less per capita than Germany or the US

Per Capita CO₂ Among Wealthy Nations



Why the difference?

France, the UK, and Portugal have much lower per capita emissions than Germany, the Netherlands, or the US — largely because a higher share of their electricity comes from nuclear and renewables.

Key insight

Countries with similar prosperity levels can have very different per capita emissions.

Policy implication

Energy technology and policy choices can decouple prosperity from emissions.

Key Takeaways

Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

01 No peak yet

Global emissions exceed 35 Bt/yr and continue to rise, despite slowing growth in recent years.

02 China: largest emitter, but below US per capita

China emits ~31% of global CO₂ annually, yet its per capita rate (~9 t) remains 36% below the US (~14 t).

03 Historical dominance by Europe and the US

Europe and the US accounted for >90% of emissions in 1900; today they represent less than one-third.

04 Massive per capita inequality persists

A 150× gap between the poorest nations (~0.1 t/person) and the richest large emitters (~14 t/person).

05 Energy policy can decouple prosperity from emissions

France and the UK demonstrate that wealthy nations can achieve far lower per capita emissions through nuclear and renewables.